



1-YEAR TEAM PLAN

3 → 11 people.
Go HAM.

The hiring plan that gets us from SAFE to Seed with first revenue, 5 design partners, SOC 2, and patents filed.

Internal Planning • Confidential • April 2026

Three people. Full product. **Zero revenue.**

We built the hardest thing first — the platform. Now we need the team to sell it, support it, and scale it.



Annaliese Parker

FOUNDER / CEO

Product vision, architecture, fundraising, investor relationships, everything else.

Product

Architecture

Fundraising

Strategy



Software Engineer

ENGINEERING

Core product development. Canvas, React Flow, SysML parser, data model.

Frontend

Backend

SysML



Product Manager

PRODUCT

Requirements, prioritization, customer research, feature specs, roadmap.

Roadmap

Research

Specs

MISSING
Sales / BD

MISSING
Solutions Eng

MISSING
ML / AI Eng

MISSING
Security / Compliance

Hit these gates or the seed doesn't happen.

Every hire maps directly to one of these milestones. No vanity hires. No nice-to-haves.

1 5 Design Partners

Active, deploying, providing feedback. LOIs signed. At least 2 in regulated industries.

Gate: Month 6

2 \$100K+ ARR

First paying customers converted from design partners. Real revenue, not LOIs.

Gate: Month 10

3 SOC 2 Type 1

Audit passed. Unblocks enterprise pipeline and defense prospects.

Gate: Month 9

4 2 Patents Filed

Provisional applications for decision graph and ambient ML architecture.

Gate: Month 4

5 Jarvis Phase 2

Gap detection shipping to design partners. The AI moat is real, not a slide.

Gate: Month 8

6 Seed-Ready Metrics

Pipeline of 20+ prospects. NRR > 100%. Usage data proving retention.

RECORDINGS

8 hires in 12 months. Every one maps to a gate.

Staggered hiring to ramp burn gradually. Front-load engineering and domain expertise, then layer on sales and compliance.

Q1
Month 1–3

#4 Solutions Architect

Speaks SysML fluently. Runs design partner onboarding. Does demos that close deals.

Unlocks: Design partner LOIs

#5 Senior Full-Stack Engineer

Collaboration, server infra, deployment pipeline. Doubles eng velocity.

Unlocks: Enterprise-ready product

Q2
Month 4–6

#6 Head of GTM / BD

Works the pipeline. Converts intros into design partners. Builds the outbound engine.

Unlocks: 5 design partners by M6

#7 ML / AI Engineer

Jarvis pipeline: context extraction, gap detection, suggestion ranking. The moat builder.

Unlocks: Jarvis Phase 2 by M8

Q3
Month 7–9

#8 Security & Compliance Lead

Owns SOC 2 audit, security posture, and compliance documentation. FedRAMP prep.

Unlocks: SOC 2 Type 1 by M9

#9 Customer Success Engineer

Onboards design partners, collects feedback, drives adoption metrics, runs training.

Unlocks: 90%+ DP retention

Q4
Month 10–12

#10 Account Executive

Converts design partners to paid. Builds pipeline for seed-stage growth. Commission-heavy.

Unlocks: \$100K+ ARR by M10

Q1: MONTH 1-3

Foundation. 3 → 5 people.

Two hires that unlock everything downstream. Without domain credibility and eng velocity, nothing else works.



Solutions Architect

Hire #4 • Month 1-2

PROFILE

10+ years in MBSE / systems engineering. Has used Cameo, DOORS, or Jama. Can speak ISO 26262 or DO-178C. Has sold or pre-sold enterprise tools before.

DAY-TO-DAY

Runs design partner onboarding. Builds demo environments. Creates migration playbooks. Does technical deep-dives with prospects.

Cash
\$130K

Equity
1.50%



Senior Full-Stack Engineer

Hire #5 • Month 2-3

PROFILE

5+ years TypeScript/React. Experience with real-time systems (WebSockets, CRDTs). Has shipped enterprise SaaS. Can own a vertical slice.

DAY-TO-DAY

Owns server infra, collaboration layer, and deployment pipeline. Pairs with existing eng on canvas performance. On-call for design partner issues.

Cash
\$145K

Equity
1.25%

Q1 Exit Criteria: 2 design partner LOIs signed. Product deployed to first partner. Patents filed.

Monthly burn: \$35K → \$60K | Headcount: 3 → 5

Acceleration.

5 → 7 people.

This is where we go from "interesting product" to "pipeline machine." Sales engine starts. AI moat gets real.



Head of GTM / Business Development

Hire #6 • Month 4

PROFILE

B2B enterprise sales background, ideally in dev tools, PLM, or defense tech. Has sold \$100K+ ACV deals. Comfortable with long sales cycles and technical buyers.

DAY-TO-DAY

Converts warm intros (Cameron, Krish network) into design partners. Builds outbound playbook. Qualifies enterprise prospects. Owns pipeline CRM.

Cash
\$120K

OTE
\$180K

Equity
1.50%



ML / AI Engineer

Hire #7 • Month 5

PROFILE

3+ years applied ML. Experience with embeddings, retrieval, and ranking systems. Comfortable with local-first inference (ONNX, WASM). Bonus: NLP or knowledge graph background.

DAY-TO-DAY

Builds Jarvis Phase 1-2: context pipeline, gap detection engine, suggestion ranking. Works with the semantic context contract. Ships ML features to design partners.

Cash
\$155K

Equity
1.25%

Q2 Exit Criteria: 5 design partners active. Jarvis Phase 1 shipping. Pipeline of 10+ qualified prospects.

Monthly burn: \$60K → \$90K | Headcount: 5 → 7



Compliance & Retention.

7 → 9 people.

Enterprise buyers won't sign without SOC 2. Design partners won't stay without support. This quarter unblocks both.



Security & Compliance Lead

Hire #8 • Month 7

PROFILE

SOC 2 implementation experience (has done it at least once before). Security engineering chops — can write code, not just policies. Bonus: FedRAMP awareness.

WHY NOW, NOT EARLIER

SOC 2 prep takes 3-4 months of focused work. Hiring at M7 means audit-ready by M9-10. Earlier would waste cycles on a product still changing rapidly.

Cash
\$150K

Equity
0.75%



Customer Success Engineer

Hire #9 • Month 8

PROFILE

Technical CS background — can debug product issues and write small scripts. Systems engineering familiarity preferred. Empathetic, organized, metrics-driven.

WHY NOW

By M8, 5 design partners are active. Without dedicated CS, the founder and solutions architect become the bottleneck. This hire frees them to sell.

Cash
\$110K

Equity
0.75%

Q3 Exit Criteria: SOC 2 Type 1 audit passed. Jarvis Phase 2 shipping. Design partner NPS > 50.
First paid conversion in progress.

Monthly burn: \$90K → \$115K | Headcount: 7 → 9

Revenue & Scale.

9 → 11 people.

Convert design partners to paying customers. Build the pipeline that makes the seed deck write itself.



Account Executive

Hire #10 • Month 10

PROFILE

Quota-carrying AE with enterprise B2B experience. \$100K–\$500K ACV range. Hungry, early-stage mentality. Can navigate procurement in regulated industries.

DAY-TO-DAY

Converts warm pipeline (design partners + inbound from SOC 2 / conference exposure). Runs demos with solutions architect. Owns CRM and forecast.

Base
\$100K

OTE
\$200K

Equity
0.50%



Senior Engineer #2

Hire #11 • Month 11

PROFILE

Infrastructure + platform focus. Experience with Docker, on-prem deployment, enterprise auth (SAML/OIDC). Has dealt with air-gapped environments.

DAY-TO-DAY

On-prem deployment package. Enterprise SSO integration. API hardening and rate limiting. Prepares the platform for defense/gov customers post-seed.

Cash
\$150K

Equity
0.50%

Q4 Exit Criteria: \$100K+ ARR. 20+ prospect pipeline. On-prem pilot deployed. Seed deck ready.

Monthly burn: \$115K → \$140K | Headcount: 9 → 11

From founder-does-everything to functional leads.

ENGINEERING (4 PEOPLE BY M12)

Lead Founder (architecture + product)

IC SW Engineer (existing — canvas, SysML)

Q1 Sr. Full-Stack Engineer (server, collab)

Q2 ML/AI Engineer (Jarvis pipeline)

Q4 Sr. Engineer #2 (infra, on-prem)

GO-TO-MARKET (4 PEOPLE BY M12)

Lead Head of GTM (pipeline, strategy)

Q1 Solutions Architect (demos, onboarding)

Q3 Customer Success Eng (retention)

Q4 Account Executive (quota-carrying)

PRODUCT & COMPLIANCE (3 PEOPLE BY M12)

IC Product Manager (existing)

Q3 Security & Compliance Lead

THE NUMBERS

\$1.7M all-in.
\$1.5–2M SAFE required.

Monthly Burn Ramp

12-Month Budget

Category	Annual
People (salaries + taxes)	\$1,100K
SOC 2 audit + tooling	\$50K
Legal (IP, entity, contracts)	\$80K
Infrastructure + tooling	\$60K
Patent filings (2 provisionals)	\$25K
Travel, conferences, events	\$40K
AI compute (LLM APIs, GPU)	\$30K
Buffer (contingency)	\$135K
Total	\$1,520K

Conservative: assumes full cash comp. Equity-heavy packages could reduce to ~\$1.3M.

Below-market cash. Above-market equity.

Total Y1 equity grants: 8.0% from the ESOP pool. Enough to recruit A-players who believe in the graph.

Y1 Equity Budget (from 15% ESOP)

Hire	Cash	Equity	Vesting
Solutions Architect	\$130K	1.50%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Sr. Full-Stack Engineer	\$145K	1.25%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Head of GTM	\$120K	1.50%	4yr / 1yr cliff
ML/AI Engineer	\$155K	1.25%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Security & Compliance	\$150K	0.75%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Customer Success Eng	\$110K	0.75%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Account Executive	\$100K+	0.50%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Sr. Engineer #2	\$150K	0.50%	4yr / 1yr cliff
Total Y1 Grants		8.00%	7.00% remaining

Comp Philosophy

- 1 Cash: 75–85% of market.** We're upfront about this. Below-market cash is the cost of admission to an early-stage rocket ship.
- 2 Equity: 2–3x market.** At a \$8M cap, 1% = \$80K paper value. At a \$28M seed, 1% = \$280K. The upside is real.
- 3 Vesting: standard 4/1.** No games. One-year cliff, then monthly. Acceleration on change of control.
- 4 Revisit at seed.** Cash bumps to market rate when seed closes. Early team is rewarded, not punished.

RISK MATRIX

What breaks if we don't hire?

Each hire de-risks a specific failure mode. Missing any one doesn't kill us, but missing two or more compounds fast.

If we don't hire...	What breaks	Severity	Mitigation
Solutions Architect	Design partners can't onboard. Founder burns 60%+ of time on demos instead of product/fundraising.	Critical	Contractor SE as bridge, but won't close deals
Sr. Full-Stack Engineer	Eng velocity stays at 1x. Collaboration features delayed. Design partners hit bugs with no one to fix them fast.	Critical	Founder codes more, but fundraising suffers
Head of GTM	Pipeline stays warm-intro-only. No outbound engine. Design partner target at risk.	High	Founder sells, but at the cost of product focus
ML/AI Engineer	Jarvis stays at Phase 0. The "AI moat" is a pitch slide, not a product. Investors see through it.	Critical	Use off-the-shelf LLM wrapper (but no moat)
Security & Compliance	SOC 2 delayed. Enterprise deals stall. Defense pipeline frozen.	High	Vanta + consultant, slower but viable
Customer Success	Design partners churn or go silent. No usage data for seed deck. SA becomes full-time support.	High	SA absorbs, but onboarding new DPs slows
Account Executive	Design partners stay free. Revenue gate (\$100K ARR) missed. Seed narrative weakens.	High	GTM lead converts first deals (slower ramp)
Sr. Engineer #2	On-prem delayed. Enterprise pilot not ready. Post-seed velocity is lower.	Medium	Defer to post-seed; manageable

Non-negotiable hires: Solutions Architect, Sr. Engineer, and ML/AI Engineer. Without these three, the product, the moat, and the design partner motion all fail. Everything else can be delayed or

How we find these people without a recruiter budget.



Network-First Hiring

Every team member and advisor sends 10 targeted LinkedIn messages. Referral bonus: \$5K equity top-up per successful hire.



INCOSE / MBSE Community

The solutions architect lives in this world. Post in INCOSE chapters, MBSE forums, LinkedIn SE groups. These people want to build the future of their field.



Counter-Positioning Pitch

"Big tool vendor innovation is dead. We're building what they can't copy. Join now, own 1%+ of the category winner." This pitch resonates with frustrated domain experts.



Remote-First

No geographic constraints. US time zones preferred but not required. Access the entire talent pool, not just SF/NYC/Austin.



Speed Kills

Offer within 48hrs of final interview. Skip the multi-week process. Send the SAFE deck to candidates — transparency builds trust.

Every hire has a job: hit a seed gate.

Month	Headcount	Hire	Milestone Unlocked	Burn
M1	3 → 4	Solutions Architect	First design partner demo delivered	\$45K
M2–3	4 → 5	Sr. Full-Stack Engineer	Product deployed to first partner. 2 LOIs signed.	\$58K
M4	5 → 6	Head of GTM	Pipeline of 10+ prospects. 2 patents filed.	\$72K
M5	6 → 7	ML/AI Engineer	Jarvis Phase 1 (context pipeline) live	\$85K
M6	7	—	5 design partners active ✓	\$88K
M7	7 → 8	Security & Compliance	SOC 2 prep started. Security posture hardened.	\$100K
M8	8 → 9	Customer Success Eng	Jarvis Phase 2 (gap detection) shipping ✓	\$110K
M9	9	—	SOC 2 Type 1 passed ✓	\$112K
M10	9 → 10	Account Executive	\$100K+ ARR ✓ (first paid conversions)	\$125K
M11	10 → 11	Sr. Engineer #2	On-prem deployment working. Enterprise pilot.	\$138K
M12	11	SEED READY	\$100K+ ARR • 5 DPs • SOC 2 • 20+ pipeline • Jarvis live	\$140K



Raise the SAFE. Hire the team. **Go HAM.**

12 months. 8 hires. 6 gates.

From pre-revenue to seed-ready.

SAFE Target	\$1.5-2M
Team at M12	11 people (5 eng / 4 GTM / 1 sec / 1 PM)
Revenue Gate	\$100K+ ARR by month 10
ESOP Used	8.0% of 15% pool → 7% remaining for seed hires
Seed Position	Revenue + SOC 2 + AI moat + 20 prospects = strong hand

Luvian Confidential. Internal Planning.